

GROUP D

International Communication Plan



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1 Introduction

1.1 Kasteel Rouge

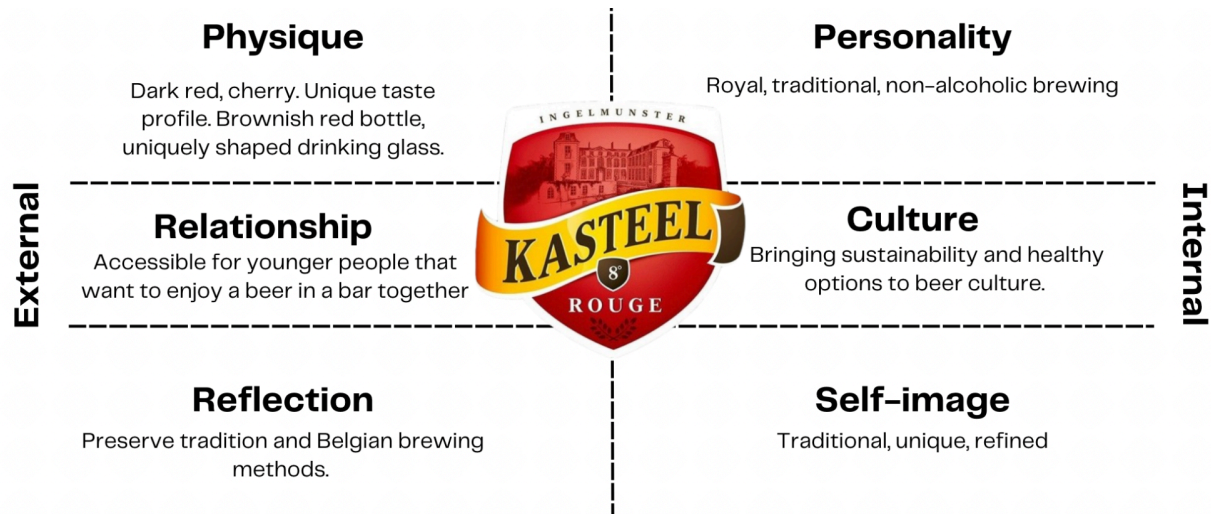
Kasteel is a Belgian Beer brand founded in 1811, and has since had a rich history of different beers and tastes. Their most notorious beer is Kasteel Rouge, a cherry-flavored beer with 8% alcohol inside. It is mostly drunk by young people between the ages of 18 and 25. Our business idea consists of bringing the beer to the Austrian beer market, but adapting it to the current trend of non-alcoholic beer. Our new Austrian product will revolve around SDG #3 and SDG #12, because we want to create a beer that's healthier by taking out the alcohol, as well as produce it locally in Austria, in order to reduce mass export and importation, meaning we'll reduce green gas emissions by producing it locally.

1.2 Global Marketing Plan

Kasteel's global marketing plan focuses on introducing Kasteel to the Austrian market by targeting bars and leveraging the uniqueness of the product compared to what is currently available. We chose a very specific target group, young people searching for non-alcoholic beers that are pleasant to drink. Since there are over 600 different beers, primarily traditional lagers holding 60% market share (Euromonitor International, 2023), we wanted to place emphasis on what differentiates Kasteel from our competitors. To do this, we are highlighting the unique flavor and our alignment with SDG #12, promoting eco-friendly consumption and production and #3, advocate for a health-conscious lifestyle.

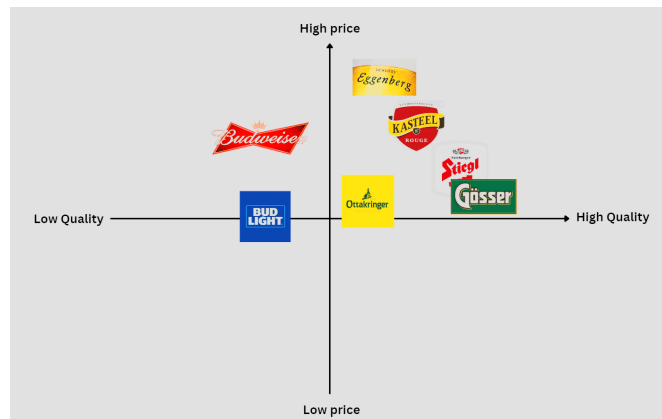
2 Assessing the Present Communication Situation

2.1 Identity Prism



Kasteel's main external physical features are that it's a dark red, cherry beer with a unique taste profile. It is usually sold in stores in a brownish-red bottle or served in bars in a uniquely shaped drinking glass. Additionally, Kasteel's internal personality is that it's a royal, traditional, and authentic non-alcoholic brew. Furthermore, Kasteel's external relationship is that it's accessible for younger people who want to enjoy a beer in a bar together. Moreover, its internal culture represents sustainability and healthy options in the beer culture. The external reflection emphasizes preserving tradition and Belgian brewing methods. Overall, Kasteel's self-image is that it's traditional, unique, and refined.

2.2 Desired Positioning



In the Austrian market, Kasteel Rouge seeks to position itself as a premium, non-alcoholic cherry beer that offers a sophisticated and health-conscious alternative to traditional beers. On the positioning map, it falls into the mid-high price and mid-high quality categories. By highlighting these attributes, the product appeals to the target consumer group.

3 Integrated Communication

3.1 Corporate Communication

The corporate communication encompasses both internal and external communication, ensuring a coherent and consistent message across all channels and to all stakeholders, supporting the overall brand and corporate objectives. These goals and objectives therefore will serve as guidelines for both internal and external communication.

3.1.1 SWOT

Strengths	Corporate identity	Unique flavor profile	Strong brand	Craftsmanship & Rich heritage	Versatility	Weakness	Brand awareness	Premium price	Media presence	Dependence on local Suppliers	Limited Availability	Total
Opportunities												
Market size + growth	4	4	4	3	4		4	4	5	3	4	20
Growing demand for non-alc	3	2	5	5	1		4	5	5	4	4	19
Partnership	5	4	5	4	4		5	1	5	4	2	12
Sustainability	4	0	3	2	1		4	3	4	3	1	20
Customer loyalty	4	5	4	4	2		5	3	3	0	1	31
Threats												
Established competitors (preference for Austrian)	5	5	5	5	3		5	5	5	5	3	25
Consumer preference for flavored beer is declining	2	4	2	4	3		2	4	2	1	3	14
Distribution difficulties (gaining access to distribution channels)	5	4	5	3	3		5	4	4	1	2	36
Legal Regulatory	4	0	0	0	0		3	0	3	4	0	14
Environmental Regulatory	4	2	4	0	0		4	0	4	5	0	25
	22	20	23	30	21		23	24	40	30	20	

3.1.2 Corporate Communication Goals

The primary goal of corporate communication for Kasteel Rouge in the Austrian market is to establish and maintain a favorable brand identity. This involves building brand awareness and creating a strong market presence. Based on the previously identified identity prism, the brand image will highlight Kasteel Rouge's unique taste profile with its non-alcoholic beer, its traditional and refined brewing, and its strong culture of bringing sustainability and healthier options to the beer culture. These elements will differentiate Kasteel Rouge from local and international competitors and drive sales growth in the Austrian craft beer segment. Additionally, a key goal is to emphasize the company's commitment to sustainability by integrating SDG #3 and SDG #12 into the core brand messaging.

3.1.3 Corporate Communication Objectives

We have defined several corporate communication objectives for Kasteel Rouge in the Austrian market. The primary aim is to increase brand awareness by achieving significant brand recognition among Austrian consumers, using both traditional and digital media channels to reach a broad audience. It is crucial to emphasize on the unique qualities and heritage of Kasteel Rouge, its Belgian origin and its distinctive cherry taste, as well as highlighting the artisanal brewing process and the usage of locally sourced ingredients. Building strong relationships with key stakeholders, such as distributors, retailers, and key influencers in the Austrian beer market, and engaging with beer enthusiasts and craft beer communities is also a priority in creating initial exposure. Generating trial and adoption is another key corporate communication objective for Kasteel Rouge, aimed at driving initial consumer engagement through sampling events, promotions, and partnerships with local retailers and restaurants. By doing so, Kasteel Rouge seeks to convert trial users into loyal customers, with the expected conversion rate of 15%, thereby increasing market penetration and fostering brand loyalty. Moreover, communicating the company's CSR initiatives and achievements is essential to demonstrate Kasteel Rouge's commitment to sustainability and social responsibility.

3.1.4 Corporate Communication Target Audience(s)

The corporate communication strategy for Kasteel Rouge targets personal internal relations, customers, shareholders, suppliers, competitors, media, general public, and the government.

3.1.5 Corporate Communication Message

The corporate communication message is to clearly communicate the brand's unique selling points, heritage, commitment to sustainability, and strategic objectives to all relevant stakeholders in the Austrian market.

3.2 Internal Communication

Internal communications refers to all communication that takes place within Kasteel Brouwerij. Effective internal communications are crucial for any business to operate within set targets and achieve strategic goals.

3.2.1 Internal Communication Goals

The internal communication goals for Kasteel Brouwerij as it expands into the Austrian market are ensuring alignment, collaboration, and enhancing employee engagement and motivation. This can be further narrowed down to our objective, a 90% engagement rate.

3.2.2 Internal Communication Objectives

The internal communication objective is to reach a 90% engagement rate among employees. This is crucial to the success of Kasteel as engaged employees are not only more likely to be innovative and creative but they also effectively communicate and implement their ideas. Research has also shown that employees who are engaged and feel valued within a company are more empowered to contribute (Teimouri et al., 2016).

3.2.3 Internal Communication Target Audience(s)

Our internal communication strategy targets primarily the employees of Kasteel Brouwerij, this includes the executive leadership team, middle management and staff. The objective will be achieved through targeting this audience directly. First, guidelines for communication will be created, then providing training and encouraging employee participation and organizing consistent department meetings. Taking these steps will ensure that the objective of a 90% engagement rate is met.

3.2.4 Internal Communication Message

The internal communication message is that employee engagement is expected and crucial for the success of Kasteels entry into the Austrian non-alcoholic beer market.

3.3 External Communications

External Communications for Kasteel Rouge will be mainly about communication between Kasteel Rouge and audiences outside of the organization like customers, general public. External communications are crucial to promote Kasteel Rouge products efficiently.

3.3.1 External Communication Goals

In order for Kasteel Brouwerij to successfully enter the Austrian market, it must maintain a smooth and continuous relationship with Austrian suppliers and effectively advertise the products produced based on this. For this purpose, we have to analyze the overall external circumstances for Kasteel Brouwerij's entry into Austrian market based on PESTEL Analysis and Porter's Five Forces model. Through these analyses, Kasteel Brouwerij should figure out Austrian culture and sentiment for creating appropriate advertisements and promotions. Also they have to find the right distribution enterprises for producing.

3.3.2 External Communication Objectives

Objective of Kasteel Brouwerij's external communication will be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-based (SMART). According to our SMART goals, our main objectives will be raising awareness of the brand and progressing measurements of our external communications.

Specific: The SMART objective we have chosen is to reach a 0,5% brand market share in the first year of our beer being available in the market.

Measurable: This goal is easily measurable, brand market share is calculated by either units sold or revenue, by dividing the sales of our beers compared to total beer sales.

Achievable: This percentage was chosen because the Austrian beer market is saturated with well-known brands, which range in brand market share from 12.3% to 1.1%, with 27.8% of shares

belonging to other brands (Euromonitor International, 2023). Because this market is hard to break into, even though 1% is a low brand market share, it would be a sign that the beer is accepted by consumers on a large scale. Drinking culture in Austria is one of the most prevalent in the entirety of Europe, as it seems a lot of activities are planned for drinking. However, in recent years the consumption of alcohol-free beer has been steadily increasing. With these two factors in mind, it should be achievable to bring a new beer that fits those characteristics onto the Austrian market.

Relevant: We're responding to the growing demand for alcohol-free beverages in Austria, tapping into a market segment that aligns with consumer preferences and health-conscious trends. With that, we're capitalizing on the popularity and reputation of Kasteel Rouge to introduce a new product variant that meets the evolving needs of Austrian consumers. This goal is relevant to our company because achieving this would indicate that we are on the right track and can set a larger goal.

Time-based: The chosen time is one year. This duration was chosen because we aim to have a strong launch campaign that will attract enough customers for the sales to reach this goal. It is crucial to regularly monitor sales performance and consumer feedback to make adjustments and improvements within quarterly review periods.

3.3.3 External Communication Target Audience(s)

Our main target audiences of external communication strategy would be the Austrian general public, customers, and distribution companies. Our primary goals of external communication is increasing awareness of our product in the Austrian market therefore Kasteel Brouwerij has to accomplish the objectives with these target audiences. Through advertising and marketing campaigns like guerilla marketing, social media campaigns, and display advertisements we can reach the audiences with our brand and product.

3.3.4 External Communication Message

The external communication message is that Kasteel Brouwerij should make actions for communications with its customers and promote their products' value through continuous advertisements and marketing campaigns and measurement.

4 Planning

4.1 International Communication Planning

The overall purpose of our communication plan is to use a strategic approach to effectively communicate the unique value proposition of Kasteel Rouge in the Austrian market. By integrating market insights, consumer preferences, and industry trends, we can tailor a specific campaign that resonates with our target audience and maximizes brand visibility and engagement.

4.1.1 International Communication Objectives

To begin with, a successful international communication plan requires a clear definition of objectives. Considering that we aim to internationalize Kasteel Rouge into the Austrian market for the first time, our main objectives are to raise brand awareness and build a strong brand image. These objectives will guide our efforts, ensuring that our communication strategies are aligned with our goals and effectively resonate with our audience.

4.1.2 International Market Analysis & Target Audience

Based on our research, we discovered that Austrians are heavy beer consumers. In 2022, they had the second highest volume of beer consumed per capita in Europe, preceded by the Czech Republic (Pollet, 2020). Moreover, a popular trend among Austrian beer consumers is the rise in preference for small-scale breweries, which produce higher quality, authentic craft beers (Statista, 2024).

Additionally, to adapt to the growing preference for non-alcoholic beer, we introduced a non-alcoholic option to the local market. Our established target audience is people aged 20-45 with middle to upper income, who value quality, authenticity, and sustainability in their beverage choices.

4.1.3 Buyer Persona



Marie

Background:

- 23 years, single;
- Bachelor degree in Marketing;
- Works in an advertising agency;
- Income: 3500 EUR/month
- Hobbies: painting, yoga, hiking and going out with her friends;
- Likes to experiment and try out different things every day;

Challenges:

- Wants to reduce alcohol consumption without compromising her social life;
- Struggles with finding a non-alcoholic alternative in bars;

4.1.4 Customer Journey & Touchpoints

To design an effective international communication plan and strategy, we can use a customer journey tool for our ideal buyer persona. This tool will help us map out each stage of their interaction with our brand, ensuring consistent and targeted messaging that resonates with their needs and preferences.

Stage	Touchpoints	Reasoning
Awareness	Guerrilla marketing; Influencer marketing; Beer promotion events;	A creative guerrilla marketing campaign is a powerful tool to capture Marie's attention, as its uniqueness and the element of surprise will engage her. Furthermore, Marie is young and she spends lots of time on social media. Collaborations with local influencers who focus on sustainability, socializing, and lifestyle will resonate with Marie's interests and values. Lastly, hosting events at trendy venues where Marie and her peers socialize will create memorable interactions and positive associations with the brand.
Consideration	Website optimization and social media (ex. adapting content and blog posts in German, creating a special Instagram page for Austria);	At this stage, Marie is familiar with the brand, yet she remains uncertain about making a purchase. Optimizing the website for a smoother user experience and crafting authentic storytelling in German on social media platforms will foster greater trust.
Purchase	Bars; Local retailers; In-store incentives; E-commerce platforms;	Like any customer, Marie prefers convenient purchasing options, so availability on popular e-commerce platforms and local retailers is crucial. In-store incentives like "buy a pack of beers, get one glass for free" can create an even stronger bond with Kasteel. With this offer, not only does she get the beer, but also an authentic Kasteel glass, enhancing her connection with the brand.
Loyalty	Word-of-mouth User-generated content	Marie is satisfied with the product and gladly recommends it to her friends and family. Additionally, she shares her love for the beer by posting stories on her Instagram when she goes out and orders it.

4.2 Timing

This project will start in the month of January 2026 and end with an evaluation in December 2026, taking one year.

4.2.1 Market Share Goal

The non-alcoholic beer market has been on a steady rise since 2018. In 2018, it was worth 31.8 million dollars, it's currently worth 66.9 million dollars in 2024 and it is expected to reach 73.9

million by the year 2026. The total beer market will be worth 1.416 billion by then, so the non-alcohol beer market will represent 5.2% of the total beer market.

We plan to achieve a market share of the general Austrian beer market share of 0.5% in the span of a year, so by the end of 2026, which equals to about 7 million dollars. This means that our budget is 700 000 dollars or 645 225 euros. We believe this is achievable because of the steady incline towards non-alcoholic beverage consumption, as well as the Austrian taste pallet aligning with the sweet flavors of Kasteel Rouge.

4.2.2 Marketing plan

In terms of marketing, we intend to focus on the following approaches in the first three months: guerilla marketing, press release events, contacting strategic partners, like for example youth organizations that promote the smart consumption of alcohol.

As time progresses and people become aware of our new product, we think it's best to focus on more widespread communication such as display ads, social media campaigns as well as collaborations with influencers. At the end of 2026, we hope to have created a clear image of what Kasteel is, using a consistent tone of voice, marketing strategy and social media posting schedule.

4.3 Evaluation and control

It is important to control and evaluate the action of the communication of Kasteel. The evaluation of the quality will be done on several kinds of communication such as internal communication, marketing communication, corporate communication, ... This will allow Kasteel to know if the communication has reached the right targets, if there have been positive quantified effects (on sales, the number of followers on social networks, ...) but also to know if the message is passed correctly (what consumers have understood). For Kasteel, the issue will be whether consumers have understood the environmental and health aspects of this new beer.

The quality of communication was demonstrated by clarity, environmental focus, consistency, responsiveness and efficiency. To achieve this quality of communication, Kasteel must remain faithful to its brand image, support the ecological dimension of the new product, and have an impactful communication with figures (such as: 0% alcohol). Kasteel must send a clear message to consumers about its new product while remaining in the Kasteel DNA that loyal consumers know.

4.3.1 Key Performance Indicators

First of all Kasteel will have to identify key performance indicators such as awareness, engagement (number of likes) and figures (sales, registrations, views on the website,...) in line with the fixed SMART objectives beforehand.

4.3.2 Collect of Data & Analysis

Then to collect data, we will need several tools such as google analytics, monitoring tools on social networks and the website, implementation of questionnaires and surveys to customers,...)

Once these data are collected, Kasteel will be able to analyze them and draw conclusions. We can perform two types of analysis: quantitative (to analyze the numbers, the number of sales...) and qualitative (for questionnaires, customer reviews,...). We can make correlations between elements of communication and certain data.

4.3.3 Conclusion & Improvement

Finally, Kasteel will be able to compare these analyses with its initial objectives and conclude the benefits or losses. Thus, After the evaluation of the communication and an exchange with the different teams, Kasteel will be able to set new objectives and improve its future communication campaigns based on the feedback of the previous one.

4.4 Future

Future communication for Kasteel Rouge should focus on strengthening internal culture and enhancing external engagement. Internally, this includes regular workshops, newsletters, feedback mechanisms, and recognition programs to foster employee involvement and transparency. Externally, Kasteel Rouge should leverage social media campaigns, website content, and customer engagement initiatives like loyalty programs and events to share its unique brand story and connect with customers. Additionally, media relations and sustainability efforts should be highlighted through press releases and community involvement. By integrating these strategies, Kasteel Rouge aims to build a compelling brand presence and drive positive stakeholder engagement.

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Work done remotely by Lucile Demol :

4.3 Evaluation and Control

4.3.1 Key Performance Indicators

4.1.2 Collection of Data & Analysis

4.1.3 Conclusion & Improvements